



Hydrogen Power

Gautam Adani's deal spree continues. This time, France's TotalEnergies SE will pick up 25 per cent stake in Adani New Energies. The objective is to build the "world's biggest hydrogen ecosystem", for which the two companies will invest \$50 billion over the next 10 years. This beefs up Adani's green energy story and its relationship with Total, which invested earlier in Adani Gas and Adani Green Energy.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



REVVING UP FOR REVLOIN?

MUKESH AMBANI wants a bigger piece of the consumer's wallet. From staple foods to fashion brands to electronics, he is everywhere. Now, reports say Reliance is looking to acquire cosmetics giant Revlon, which has filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy. The Reliance boss wants a play in the beauty space and this will give him an international footprint. Revlon, with a \$3-billion debt, needs help. Will Reliance extend its hand?

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

BATTLING MINISTER

COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY Minister Piyush Goyal was seen in combative mode at the 12th ministerial conference of the World Trade Organization. He pressed India's case for allowing countries to export foodgrain from public stockpiles for humanitarian and food aid purposes, delivered India's demand for patent waivers as part of the international response to Covid-19, and voiced suspicion that the Uruguay round of asymmetries and discrimination in agriculture is being sought to be institutionalised in fishing.

—RAJAT MISHRA



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Yes, Mr Secretary

FINANCE SECRETARY T.V. Somanathan has pressed for reforming India's poorly targeted subsidies such as those for electricity and fertilisers, to improve the quality of public expenditure. Besides, he has underlined the importance of reducing the fiscal deficit, particularly at the Centre, minimising external debt, as well as fostering a strong domestic investment climate. Good thoughts all.

—RAJAT MISHRA

UP, UP AND UP

The valuation story of Cred isn't slowing down. A recent fund infusion of \$140 million by Singapore's GIC, Tiger Global, FalconEdge and Dragonee has boosted it to \$6.4 billion. Last April, Cred was valued at \$2.2 billion and in October, at \$4 billion. For Founder Kunal Shah, known for having made a killing through the sale of FreeCharge in mid-2015 to Snapdeal for \$400 million, this is history bettered.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



Bungee Jumper

RBL Bank's new MD & CEO **R. Subramaniam** played a key role in the turnaround of Indian Bank and Indian Overseas Bank. But markets are cautious as he was also the RBI-appointed administrator of failed Dewan Housing Finance Ltd. The man himself is unfazed, though: "Wherever you are, you have to make use of the platform. If the platform is efficient and strong, do a good bungee jump."

—ANAND ADHIKARI

PIYUSH GOYAL PHOTO BY SHEKHAR GHOSH; T.V. SOMANATHAN PHOTO BY YASIR IQBAL; R. SUBRAMANIAM PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE; MUKESH AMBANI PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE